enhance their own data-collection capabilities, such as deploying satellites or field agents, or tap into external sources like member states, other IOs, NGOs, and private firms.

In extreme cases of sidelining, IOs could consider expelling intransigent members, but this approach carries significant risks. Institutional rules often make expulsion procedurally complex, typically requiring broad agreement among member states. Additionally, expelling a member could backfire by severing ties with a country that may, under different leadership, become more cooperative. For example, President Joseph R. Biden Jr. re-engaged with many institutions that his predecessor, Donald Trump, had distanced the United States from, illustrating the value of maintaining formal ties. Furthermore, rejoining an IO often involves lengthy and challenging accession processes, as evidenced by China's arduous reforms to join the WTO.

Instead of pursuing such drastic measures, IOs typically opt for calculated sidelining efforts, balancing assertiveness with caution. Overzealous attempts to sideline leaders risk provoking stronger backlash, both from the leaders themselves and from their constituencies. Leaders may intensify their rhetorical attacks, accusing IOs of elitism or overreach, potentially amplifying perceptions of a "democratic deficit"—a criticism that IOs act independently of public accountability (Dahl 1999; Moravcsik 2004). This erosion of legitimacy can weaken IOs' capacity to promote and enforce global norms.

This chapter thus focuses on a more subtle and less contentious form of sidelining—enhanced collaboration among IOs. By pooling resources, sharing information, and coordinating efforts, IOs can reduce their dependence on obstructive actors while reinforcing their collective strength. Cooperation among IOs is not only cost-effective but also minimizes the political risks associated with direct confrontation, offering a practical pathway to address populist resistance.

4.2 The Role of Information in Global Governance

Information is a vital component of global governance, enabling IOs to foster cooperation, ensure compliance, and address transnational challenges. Scholars have long recognized that a core function of IOs is to collect,